MFANO BANK

A fictional bank for a portfolio project

INTERNAL CIRCULAR

New card issuance

Reference	CIR-CARD-05
Version	3
Status	Live
Effective date	2025-11-01
Owner	Cards and Payments
Approved by	Head of Branch Operations
Classification	Internal

This document is fictional. It does not describe the procedures of any real bank.

Document control

What changed in version 3: Cards and PIN mailers not collected within 60 days (previously 90) are destroyed under dual control.

Version history

Version	Effective date	Change
1	2022-04-01	First issue
2	2024-02-01	Dual control added for card and PIN receipt
3	2025-11-01	Uncollected cards destroyed after 60 days instead of 90

Approval and distribution

Approved by the Head of Branch Operations. Owned by Cards and Payments. Distributed to all branches through the intranet. Printed copies are not controlled; always check the intranet for the current version.

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1. Purpose

This circular sets out how branch staff issue a first debit card to an account holder, so that cards reach only the right person and card stock is always controlled.

2. Scope

This circular applies to all branches and to first debit cards on current and savings accounts. Replacement cards follow CIR-CARD-07.

3. Definitions

- **Card application form (Form CA-02):** the form on which the customer applies for a debit card.
- **PIN mailer:** the sealed envelope containing the card's personal identification number.
- **Card stock register:** the branch register recording every card and PIN mailer received, issued or destroyed.
- **Dual control:** two authorised staff members present and signing for the same action.

4. Roles and responsibilities

- **Customer service officer:** checks eligibility, captures the card request and hands over the card.
- **Supervisor:** authorises the request and holds one key under dual control.
- **Card centre:** produces and dispatches cards and PIN mailers.
- **Branch manager:** reviews the card stock register monthly.

5. Procedure

5.1 Check eligibility [MANDATORY CONTROL]

Confirm that the account is active and that the customer's KYC record is complete and current. Do not issue a card on a dormant account or an account with incomplete KYC.

5.2 Customer application

The customer completes and signs the card application form (Form CA-02), choosing the card type and the branch for collection.

5.3 Capture the card request

Capture the request on the card system and attach the signed Form CA-02. The first card on an account is free of charge.

5.4 Supervisor authorisation

The supervisor checks Form CA-02 against the account record and authorises the request. The supervisor must not authorise a request they captured themselves.

5.5 Receive cards and PIN mailers under dual control [MANDATORY CONTROL]

Cards and PIN mailers arrive in separate packages. Two authorised staff open them together, record each item in the card stock register and store cards and PIN mailers in separate locked drawers.

5.6 Hand over the card to the account holder only [MANDATORY CONTROL]

Hand over the card and PIN mailer only to the account holder after checking their original identity document. The customer signs the card collection register.

5.7 Uncollected cards

Cards and PIN mailers not collected within 60 days are destroyed under dual control. Record the destruction in the card stock register.

6. Exceptions and escalation

- **Joint accounts:** each account holder applies for their own card on a separate Form CA-02.
- **Accounts for minors:** cards are issued only on the written application of the parent or guardian named on the account.

7. Records and retention

Card application forms and collection register: 7 years. Records are kept in the branch file room or the document management system and destroyed only under the bank's records retention schedule. Records that are part of an open complaint, dispute, audit or investigation are kept until it is closed.

8. Monitoring and quality assurance

Back office quality assurance reviews a sample of files every month against this circular and reports exceptions to the branch manager and to Cards and Payments. Repeated exceptions at a branch are reported to the Head of Branch Operations. Internal audit may review compliance with this circular at any time.

9. Related documents

- CIR-CARD-07 Card replacement
- CIR-ACC-10 Individual account opening and KYC

Appendix A: Frequently asked questions

Q1. Is there a fee for the first card?

No. The first card on an account is free. Replacement fees are set in CIR-CARD-07.

Q2. Can a relative collect the card for the customer?

No. Cards are handed over only to the account holder.